TryHackMe Writeup

Intro to Log Analysis

DG Interns Hub - Week 3 | **Name: Harini E | Intern ID: DG/15/OCT/CYBER/040**

Platform	TryHackMe (free room)
Room	Intro to Log Analysis
Level	Easy
Room time	60 min (as shown on the room page)
Status	Completed, the room progress bar shows 100%
Room link	https://tryhackme.com/room/introtologanalysis

Overview

This room is an introduction to log analysis, best practices and the tools used for effective detection and response. It follows on from the logging basics and shows how an analyst reads logs to find suspicious activity. It matches this week's topic, because the Sysmon, auditd and Snort data all need to be analysed in this way before they become useful findings.

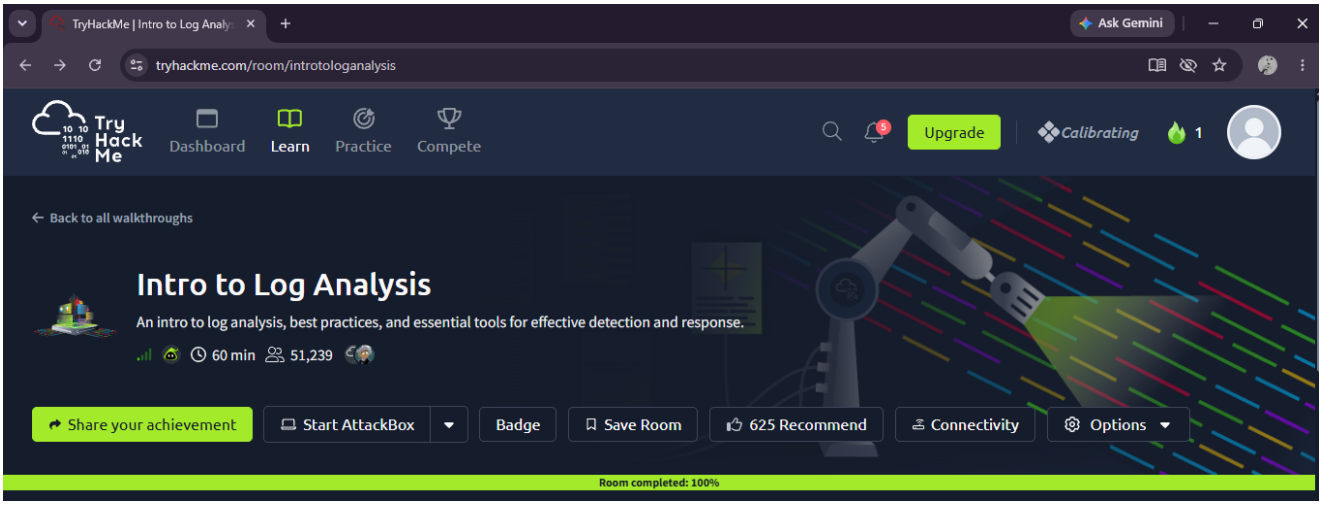
Topics I completed

Topic	Focus
Log analysis basics	What log analysis is and why it is done. Web server logs are a good example, because they record requests, IP addresses, request types and status codes.
Investigation theory	The thinking behind an investigation: asking the right questions of the logs and following the evidence step by step.
Best practices	Good habits that make log analysis accurate and repeatable.
Command line tools	Searching and filtering log files with command line tools.
CyberChef	Using CyberChef to decode and process data that is found inside logs.
Practice files	The room has downloadable log files to practise on, instead of a virtual machine.

What I took from it

The room taught me that reading a log is a skill, and that it helps to know what each field means before looking for anything unusual. Simple command line searches already answer many questions, and a tool like CyberChef helps when the data is encoded. This links to my Week 2 work, where I counted failed logons with PowerShell, and to this week's endpoint logs.

Evidence



1. Room page showing Intro to Log Analysis completed, room progress 100%